

Satan Wants to Be Worshiped

Jesus Exposed the Spirit Behind Peter's Words

Go to Matthew 16, and put a marker in Ezekiel 28 and Isaiah 14. We will see how far we get this time.

Matthew 16:20 says:

Then charged he his disciples that they should tell no man that he was Jesus the Christ.

From that time forth began Jesus to show unto his disciples how that he must go unto Jerusalem, and suffer many things of the elders and chief priests and scribes, and be killed, and be raised again the third day.

Then Peter took him, and began to rebuke him, saying, Be it far from thee, Lord: this shall not be unto thee.

But he turned, and said unto Peter, Get thee behind me, Satan: thou art an offense unto me: for thou savorest not the things that be of God, but those that be of men.

That is an interesting statement. What amazed me was that Jesus totally bypassed the man and exposed what was working behind him.

This does not surprise me now. As I get out more in religion, one of the biggest errors I see is the way people use Old Testament saints as examples of our covenant. We cannot do that. God dealt with spiritually dead men differently than He deals with spiritually alive men, which is what we are.

After all these years, when He finally says, "Now that you can hear Me enough from praying in tongues, try to go to the Old Testament and use different examples," I am not surprised. I never could get the flow to go there. When He told me why, I understood. We use them as examples for what we do and the way we live, but He said the things that happened to them happened as examples for us.

That does not mean you do not need to understand what happened to them, how it happened under the covenant they were walking under, and according to what He said. God is the same yesterday, today, and forever. He is righteous, so He has to deal with things in proportion to that. But He dealt with them differently than He deals with us.

The Debate Over Falling Under the Power Misses the Real Issue

I was talking to different ones, and a teaching seems to be gaining popularity about falling under the power.

Years ago, I went to one place to hold a revival, and they did not allow catchers. This pastor had a great revelation. The first line we had, two or three people crashed to the floor. No carpet, and their heads were bouncing like basketballs.

I said, "I will have my pilot catch."

Two of his ushers restrained my pilot. They literally held him in his chair when he tried to get up.

After that meeting was over, I said from the pulpit, "This man will trust me to teach the eternal Word of God that can shape your life forever, but he will not let me move in the Spirit. I am closing the meeting now."

He took me in and said, "In our clause we said we would not allow catchers, and you agreed to it."

I said, "If I did, I did not know it. Did we sign something? I did not know it if I did."

So, according to him, I had bound myself to my word. They only had one more night, so I finished it.

When you have genuine people in the land, like prophets, and you have history to read about men like Smith Wigglesworth and John G. Lake, and then this phenomenon begins, people can take things too far. In some places they will say, "We will no longer fall under the power because we have to stand to receive certain things."

One thing is for sure: the Body of Christ never matures at the same rate. Who is it that stops falling down under the power? Who stands there and receives? How mature do you have to be? Do babies continue to fall, and mature people stand up and receive? Where is the dividing line? How do you know the difference?

This gets into a big mess, but I understand why. One thing the Lord said to me was, "Most of them are trying to cover because they do not spend enough time with Me for Me to be present to do much of that anyway."

I can go along with that.

It was simple to them: "When Jesus prayed for people, they did not fall down." Well, when they tried to arrest Him, everybody but Jesus fell down. Of course, then the next statement is, "That was not a healing anointing."

I can tell you why people fall down, if it makes that much difference to you. Generally, it has been my experience that there is a wind that will blow on me from the outside. But it is not until that wind reaches my spirit, hardly. There is something about Him being magnified inside my born-again spirit that, temporarily, I lose it for just a second or two in my senses.

I am starting to believe that is one of the greatest benefits of God. You are coming up resisting big time. You have strongholds built in your soul, and they are feeding your intellect: "You cannot be healed. You cannot be healed." Then all of a sudden, you are under anesthetic. Your mind loses control for a second, and God runs in and slips it in on you.

When Jesus ministered to those people who got healed, they were spiritually dead. There was no magnification of His glory and power in their spirits. But under the shadow in Solomon's temple, they could not stand when His glory came in, much less under the true. When He magnifies Himself in my spirit, I have trouble standing when I am all by myself.

In that last seeking time, every time I raised my hands, He started pushing me over. Just like the man the other day. I said, "Why are you leaning at a forty-five?"

He was leaning way back, and nobody was doing anything.

I said, "Why are you leaning at a forty-five?"

He said, "Something is pushing on me."

I just lost it. It was one of the funniest things I ever heard. But he was right.

I would lift my hands, and I thought my hands were pulling me over because I was weak from fasting. So I said, "God, will You forgive me my folly?" I left my hands down, tried it again, and got braced a little. Hallelujah. He started pushing me backward again. I said, "This is really good. I really like that."

Satan Tried to Stop the Cross and Revealed His Pattern

Peter said, "No, far be it from You. You are not going to go."

Jesus said, "Get behind Me, Satan."

Isn't it something that Satan was trying to stop the cross? People say he did not know it was the Lord of glory being crucified. If that is the case, what was he trying to stop? Here he is trying to stop it, while people preach that he excited the crowd.

What got me here was how Jesus did not deal with the man. He exposed what was behind the man and said, "Get behind Me, Satan."

That is when I noticed the pattern. When Satan was taking over a nation and ruling from that nation, God would come and prophesy using the name of the king, such as the king of Tyrus or Babylon. Then He would expose Satan by the actions of that king.

I started to see this. I could understand Satan's movements better and equip myself better. The things God said about him, especially through the king of Tyrus, absolutely amazed me.

Ezekiel Reveals the Anointed Cherub Behind the King of Tyrus

Go to Ezekiel 28:12:

Son of man, take up a lamentation upon the king of Tyrus, and say unto him, Thus saith the Lord God; Thou sealest up the sum, full of wisdom, and perfect in beauty.

Thou hast been in Eden the garden of God; every precious stone was thy covering, the sardius, topaz, and the diamond, the beryl, the onyx, and the jasper, the sapphire, the emerald, and the carbuncle, and gold: the workmanship of thy tabrets and of thy pipes was prepared in thee in the day that thou wast created.

Thou art the anointed cherub that covereth; and I have set thee so: thou wast upon the holy mountain of God; thou hast walked up and down in the midst of the stones of fire.

Thou wast perfect in thy ways from the day that thou wast created, till iniquity was found in thee.

By the multitude of thy merchandise they have filled the midst of thee with violence, and thou hast sinned: therefore I will cast thee as profane out of the mountain of God: and I will destroy thee, O covering cherub, from the midst of the stones of fire.

Thine heart was lifted up because of thy beauty, thou hast corrupted thy wisdom by reason of thy brightness: I will cast thee to the ground, I will lay thee before kings, that they may behold thee.

Now this is interesting: instruments of worship, tabrets and pipes, were prepared in him from the day he was created.

When Satan begins to rule on this earth in different places, and corrupts what he begins to draw to himself, what he tries to control and what he tries to do gives you a hint of what he is after.

I could never figure his fall out. I could not see how somebody with the position he had could fall. The sum total of everything God had created pertaining to beauty and creation up to the time of his creation was created in him. The anointed cherub that covereth probably had nothing like him.

In our minds it is hard to conceive that a being could exist that close to God: an angel full of brightness, beauty, glory, wisdom, and anointing, with whom God allotted His power and presence, probably like no other creature. Yet he could fall.

His appetites are exposed when he tries to live them through men, such as these kings, collecting to himself wealth, merchandise, and reign. Whenever he gets a king who can rule enough people, the next sequence of events is that he enters into some state of deity. He begins to think he is deity. People have to come and worship him.

Jesus Withstood Satan's Temptation in Body, Soul, and Spirit

In exposing Satan, it is easy to understand what he was really after in the last thing he used on Jesus in the temptation in the wilderness.

Jesus fasted forty days, even though He had a spirit born spiritually alive. He still fasted forty days to prepare His flesh for the same kind of testing that Adam failed.

The devil came at Him three ways: spirit, soul, and body.

In the body realm, he said, "Turn these stones to bread."

In the soul realm, he wanted Him to jump off the pinnacle of the temple on a misapplication of the verse about angels keeping Him from dashing His foot against a stone. But it depends on the circumstances with which you approach the stone. When Jesus discerned it, He said, "I am not going to tempt God."

The soul realm is where emotions are generally manifested. The devil controls most people through their emotions, because when he is behind emotions, they are stronger than the will. If there is one thing that dominates will, it is emotion. He can use emotions for destruction of reasoning. No matter what you say, their minds switch off of what you are saying and onto all of what they are, their problems, and what is destroying them.

Peace is one of the most powerful attributes a person can walk by. That is why we named our set of tapes Peace: The Aggressive Weapon of God. There is no better description of peace. It is an aggressive weapon. It will stop Satan before he can get into your camp or your foundation. He can rant and rave around you and blow on your house, but when it is over, the final decision goes to you. Your house will still be standing.

You have to understand that Satan is the father of all lies. The power he held over the human race was spiritual death. Hebrews says Jesus destroyed him that had the power of death, that is, the devil. When Jesus destroyed spiritual death, He destroyed the hold Satan had over you.

"Well, I do not think so."

That is where you are.

When Jesus took that second temptation on, what He stood up under that day would put any person in the lowest level of any asylum. He had the whole machinery of a supernatural being against one Man. Then He turned around and said, "Behold, I give you power over all the power of the enemy."

That power is based on the standing He gave you. He defeated Satan with what you have, then paid the penalty for you and me and gave us His standing.

When you say, "Devil, go," I hope you do not think he leaves because of his great respect for you. He leaves because of the standing God gave you. He knows that if he does not leave, and you know who you are, the Holy Ghost is going to give him a real bad time.

Hallelujah, Jesus.

Sometimes overseas, when thirty or forty people fall down and start thrashing, with eyes rolling, you can tell because holes appear in the crowd where they are moving around. In a preacher's meeting of four thousand, about thirty or forty manifested. Some people went up and started slapping them in the face. I do not know why they do that in India.

I just say, "Look, those devils were there. They came in with you people. Now that they are coming out, why do you not let them come out? Stay out of it. If you could have gotten them out, they would have been out before you came. Let God finish."

Amen.

Then Satan moved on to the spirit. That tells you what he was after.

Satan's Corrupted Wisdom Exalts Image, Status, and Worship

What a messed-up corruption of wisdom. What a self-exalted opinion of himself. By his own brightness, his wisdom was corrupted. What kind of opinion does this being have of himself?

This helped me understand why people do certain things. Some do it innocently because they followed somebody into it who did it by deception.

We have people preaching, the Holy Ghost moving and using them for years, and one day they get a robe, put it on, with a long robe and high collar, come out, and look around. They have definitely separated themselves from us. They are a priesthood or something.

It finally troubled me because we had a rash of it. I really started wanting to know. Again He said to me, "They are demanding respect from the people that they are not getting from Me."

When you are complete in Him, the adorning He has done for you is by the Spirit: meekness, a humble spirit, His glory, and His power. When He is through adorning you, you do not need anything on your outer man that marks you as different from everybody else.

Then I remember when people got so humble that they glorified themselves for their humility. I do not know if you remember that era when you could not get them to teach unless they had Levi's and a T-shirt on. The problem was that they were under just as much bondage. If they went to a friend's wedding and had to wear a tuxedo, then had to preach afterward, they would have to stop and change into Levi's because God forbid somebody might think they were not humble.

The Lord said, "When you are complete and adorned by Me, you can put drab gray on and go sit in the corner. It does not matter, because the man is complete."

For God to expose Satan this way and show what these kings wanted, how they acted when their empires became wealthy, beautiful, exalted, and worshiped by the rest of the earth, shows what a sick creature he is. He thought Jesus would get down and worship him.

"Here is the glory of the kingdoms and the wealth of them. They will all be Yours, if You will worship me."

He wanted His worship.

When I finally saw that, I knew what God had that Satan really wanted.

Worship Was Created for Fellowship Between Creator and Created

Only God knows how long Satan reigned with Him as the anointed cherub that covereth, with his beauty, instruments of worship, and the pipes created in him on the day he was created.

When he went into an open creation to worship God, I do not know if you can imagine the beauty of looking at him as the anointed covering of everything God was. He was made to open creation to worship and fill the universe with worship.

Of all the things God has given to us and through us, He dressed the garden for Adam and made wonderful things available to him. Now in redemption, with us born again, it is God to us and through us. Even our works, the things we do for Him, are not the fellowship God is looking for.

We were created unto good works. They did not create us.

All that God has and has done comes to us and through us, and it is for us. Yet originally in creation He created us for a reason. He would not have created us if He needed nothing and no one to be with Him.

A strong attribute He has is life and love. He created us to be with Him, and He could not have created us to be with Him without wanting us to be with Him. He even calls us sons and daughters because we have been born of Him.

There is only one thing you can do that really ministers to Him: give yourself back.

The word worship was created between Creator and created. The word will not work anywhere else. To the angels, He is God Creator. To you, He is God Father.

We look at worship like, "I am supposed to give Him praise because He is God, so I will put in this much time." When God forced me into my worship closet to put in a certain amount of time, I went in there in legalism and came out as a son of God in fellowship with Him.

It is not some self-exalted, haughty God who only receives worship when you are down on your face saying, "O holy High One who could kill me and turn me into a grease spot, I had better get down and worship You."

Those days are over. Old Testament saints could not give Him the fellowship He has restored us to. You can. You have been restored into sonship.

He said:

They shall not teach every man his neighbor, saying, Know the Lord: for all shall know me, from the least to the greatest.

Every one of you has the same access to Him that any child born in a family would have. Whether you are first, fourteenth, fifteenth, or sixteenth, He is your Father, and you can approach Him like the firstborn.

That is what worship was: the fellowship He desired. When you approach Him, fellowship with Him, love Him, and glorify Him, both as God and as your Father, He will be God to you, but He will be more than that. He will be your Father.

Hello, inheritance.

Satan Coveted the Fellowship That Moves the Father's Heart

This is why we were created and born as His sons and daughters. Satan, in the eons of time, had incited worship and could fill the universe with it. Corrupted by his beauty and wisdom, he began to see that this was truly why everything existed: to fellowship with Him as Creator and as Father.

When Satan saw the pleasure worship brought the Father, he wanted it. That is where his fall came from.

When you have this body subjected to sin, pressure, and beatings, and you are consecrated to your Father, you can lift your hands and still give your Father worship. There will never be another time in your creation when you can give Him as much as you can give Him now.

After a while, when everybody is in bed and it gets early, I cannot stay there. I have to go. It may start as a chore or discipline, but it goes past that. There seems to be a call in me. I wake up sometimes at three or three-thirty in the morning, and the call says, "Come away. Come on. I am waiting. Nothing else will give you what you are about to get."

When you are in the desert, three-quarters dehydrated, what do you want? Can anything else do what a glass of water will do?

The Father Sought Worshipers Who Could Worship From a Born-Again Spirit

Go back to John 4:23-24:

But the hour cometh, and now is, when the true worshippers shall worship the Father in spirit and in truth:
for the Father seeketh such to worship him.
God is a Spirit: and they that worship him must worship him in spirit and in truth.

That hour was forty-one years long on the millennial time clock. Jesus was telling the Samaritan woman that the hour had finally come after four thousand years when the true worshipers would be able to worship Him in spirit and in truth.

The King James got "in spirit" right, because He is talking about worship out of your human spirit. Old Testament saints could not worship Him in spirit, and you can. This is positional truth.

He searched out the dispensations of four thousand years and waited for the first men to appear spiritually alive who could finally enter back into fellowship with Him.

God is a Spirit. You have been made a partaker of His divine nature. Now you can finally give Him the fellowship He lost when Adam sold the human race out to the sin nature.

King Solomon, after perfecting the shadow, came as close as you could get. He brought them to the lip of the born-again experience in shadow and type, but he could not lead them in. That is why Jesus said, "A greater than Solomon is here."

The wisdom Solomon reigned with was to his reign what the new nature is to your spirit. The candle has been brought into the dark room. All of you shall know Me from the least to the greatest, and nobody can stop anything because it is up to you.

John the Baptist was born of women, and there was none greater than John. Notwithstanding, he that is least in the kingdom of God is greater than he. Jesus separated the least in the kingdom from John, which meant John was not in the kingdom yet. Not until Jesus rose from the dead.

Then John went home, left the shadow, and went to the true in the presence of God Himself. Abraham's bosom was a nice place to wait out the dispensations, but John is not in the shadow anymore. He is in what was making the shadow: the Body of Christ.

Positional Worship Continues When Feelings Retreat

Understand that this is positional truth. If you do not, you will go into teachings that say when you worship Him in spirit and in truth, you are not really in the Spirit unless you feel Him.

He ordered me into the closet, and I went in under a legalistic mandate to spend a certain number of hours. Can you imagine telling your wife, "I am going to glorify and adore you for a couple of hours, and then time is up"?

It starts that way. He ordered me into the closet because He knew I would outlast the flesh. He knew I had a stubborn streak.

I could worship Him for an hour and say, "This is good." But after an hour, He went home. Sometimes I had to be in there four or five hours, and I could not even tell He had come to visit me. I felt like a mummy that had been unwrapped. Every breath was a little dry powder puff: "Glory. Glory. Hallelujah."

God would retreat, then come and visit me. After a while, He visited a little longer, then sometimes followed me around for a day, then a week. It got longer and longer. Then I would lift my hands, and He came every time.

Then I found out there is healing in it.

Now I finally understand why He brought me into it like He did. I legalistically outlasted all the dry spells. After you are in there for a while, you are already walking in a certain fellowship with God as far as His presence is concerned. All God does is retreat and leave you where you are really walking.

If you keep worshiping Him, all the flesh and things between you and Him get narrower and narrower until He is walking right there with you in manifested presence. That is when He stays.

"When should I start?"

Every blue-collar worker, lawyer, and king of nations has to start in the same place, because all shall know Him from the least to the greatest. He has no favorites.

"I have all my time tied up."

Yes, but three months from now it would not have to be. Just a little planning. Who do you love? What do you want?

Five years will go by, and you will be the same if you do not do something you have not done before. If you are going to change, and you have not changed in the last ten years, obviously you are going to have to do something you have not done before.

He will start coming closer and closer to the fellowship you are really walking in. Eventually, instead of retreating back to where you are really walking, He will be right there with you. Whether you feel Him or do not feel Him, it is positional truth. You are giving Him what He wants.

In fact, you are getting through more when He retreats back to where you really walk and you will not stop anyway.

"I do not care what I feel like. I am not stopping."

He likes that, because after a while that will be where you are really walking: right there with Him. You can feel His geographical, manifested, miracle-working presence in whatever house you are in, whatever hospital you go to, or wherever you go.

"I just do not have time to pray."

Come in for counsel. Bring the hours you watch television and a calculator.

God knows your heart. It may work on me, but it will not fly with Him.

We want revival. Revival is made out of heart.